MITE 435: Exam Cram Sheet and Scenario Decision Guide

Course: Software Design Patterns | **Instructor:** Md Saeed Siddik, IIT DU | A4 print edition

SECTION 1: TRADITIONAL CODE SMELLS

1.1 All 12 Smells (Fowler & Beck)

Smell	Memory hook	Trigger / symptom	Refactoring	Violates
Long Method	Does too many steps in a row	> 30 lines, commented "paragraphs"	Extract Method	SRP
Large Class (God Class)	Knows and does too much	"Does X **and** Y", > 10 fields	Extract Class / Subclass	SRP
Duplicated Code	Same logic copy-pasted	Same algorithm in several places	Extract Method, Pull Up Method	DRY
Long Parameter List	Needs > 3-4 arguments	Many positional args, easy to swap	Introduce Parameter Object	none named
Feature Envy	Method wants data of class B	Repeated getters on another object	Move Method (to data owner)	Encapsulation
Data Clumps	Same fields travel together	`(street, city, zip)`, `(startDate, endDate)`	Extract Class	none named
Switch Statements	Branches on a type code	`if (type.equals("CARD")) ... else if ...`	Replace Conditional with Polymorphism	OCP
Primitive Obsession	`String`/`int` instead of a domain object	Raw strings for phone, money, email	Replace Data Value with Object	Encapsulation
Divergent Change	**1 class**, **many** unrelated reasons to change	Change DB → edit it; change tax → edit it again	Extract Class	SRP
Shotgun Surgery	**1 change**, **many** classes edited	Add a discount → edit 10 files	Move Method, Inline Class	SRP
Inappropriate Intimacy	Classes know each other's internals	Reaching into private/internal state	Move Method, Hide Delegate	Encapsulation / Law of Demeter
Speculative Generality	Built for a future that never came (YAGNI)	Unused abstract classes, empty interfaces	Collapse Hierarchy, Inline Class	YAGNI

1.2 Look-Alike Smells (High-Yield Exam Questions)

Pair	Core difference	Ask yourself
Divergent Change vs Shotgun Surgery	**1 class, many reasons** (low cohesion) vs **1 change, many classes** (scattered coupling).	Does the tax rule touch 1 class (Divergent) or 15 files (Shotgun)?
Feature Envy vs Inappropriate Intimacy	One-way: a method uses another class's public getters. Two-way: classes probe each other's internals.	One method using getters (Envy) or two classes tied by internals (Intimacy)?
Primitive Obsession vs Data Clumps	One raw type standing in for a concept (`String phone`) vs several fields that always appear together.	One raw string needing validation, or 3 fields always together?
Long Method vs Large Class	Bloat inside one function vs bloat in a whole class (many fields and duties).	One 80-line function, or a 2,000-line class with 25 fields?
Long Parameter List vs Data Clumps	A long argument list in one method. If the same params repeat across several methods, it is a Data Clump.	5 params in one method, or the same 5 in 4 classes?

Smell vs Bug vs Debt: a *smell* is a design symptom (code works today but is brittle). A *bug* gives wrong output or a crash. *Technical debt* is the growing cost of poor design choices.

1.3 Spot-the-Smell Scanner (scan a snippet in this order)

```
1. Method > 25 lines, commented paragraphs?              -> Long Method (Extract Method)
2. if/switch on strings or type codes ("CARD", "VIP")?   -> Switch Statement (Polymorphism / Strategy)
3. a.x() uses b.getX() * b.getY() + b.getZ()?            -> Feature Envy (Move Method to B)
4. Same 3 params (start, end, tz) in 3 methods?          -> Data Clumps (Parameter Object)
5. Raw strings for domain rules (String phone = "+880")? -> Primitive Obsession (Value Object)
6. Method with 6+ params?                                -> Long Parameter List (Parameter Object)
7. Same 8 lines in 2 classes?                            -> Duplicated Code (Extract Method / Pull Up)
8. One class does DB, HTML and discounts?                -> Divergent Change / God Class (Extract Class)
```

SECTION 2: LLM CODE SMELLS

2.1 The 9 Smells (Chenail-Larcher et al. 2026)

Mental model: an LLM call is a component that needs an explicit contract with 4 clauses: **Input** (system policy, instructions, assets, context), **Model** (pinned version, reasoning effort, decoding), **Boundary** (token cap, timeout, JSON schema), **Trace** (user, audit tag, session ID).

Structural / API usage	Data semantics	Protocol (79.3% of occurrences)
NSM 25.3% | OSP 13.4% | AIC 0.7%	NSO 43.6% | RVP 18.9%	NMVP 55.1% | TNES 43.9% | UMM 42.1% | RENES 0.9%

Percent = share of the 692 studied projects with at least one occurrence (lecture v2).

Category	Code	Smell	Memory hook	Solution pattern
Structural / API usage	**NSM**	No System Message	Only a `user` role; no system persona or policy	Template Method / Strategy
	OSP	Overspecified Sampling Parameters	`temperature` + `top_p` + `top_k` all set	Strategy
	AIC	Anonymous Inference Call	No user/session ID; cannot trace or audit	Context Object / Facade
Data semantics	**NSO**	No Structured Output	JSON asked as free text, no schema check	Adapter (typed object)
	RVP	Raw Vision Payload	Uncompressed 4K images sent to a VLM	Chain of Responsibility (resize, compress, redact)
Protocol *(79.3% of occurrences)*	**NMVP**	No Model Version Pinning	Alias (`gpt-4o`) instead of a dated snapshot	Factory Method
	TNES	Temperature Not Explicitly Set	Inherits changing provider default	Factory / Config Object
	UMM	Unbounded Max Metrics	No `max_tokens`; denial-of-wallet risk	Facade / Gateway
	RENES	Reasoning Effort Not Explicitly Set	No effort setting on thinking models (o1/o3/Flash)	Strategy

2.2 Look-Alike LLM Smells

Pair	Core difference
NMVP vs TNES	Identity vs sampling. NMVP: the vendor swaps the weights behind an alias. TNES: the vendor changes the default temperature (0.7 to 1.0).
OSP vs TNES	Too many knobs vs none. OSP sets `temperature`, `top_p`, `top_k` together and they conflict. TNES sets no sampling control.
UMM vs RENES	Output limit vs thinking limit. UMM: `max_tokens` unbounded. RENES: `reasoning_effort` unbounded.
NSO vs RVP	Output defect vs input defect. NSO: structured reply treated as a free string. RVP: huge uncompressed images sent in.
NSM vs Prompt Bloat	Code defect vs text defect. NSM: no `system` message in the API payload. Prompt Bloat: 200 words of backstory inside the prompt.

SECTION 3: PROMPT SMELLS

3.1 The 10 Prompt Smells (Ronanki 2024, Della Porta 2026)

Axiom: smells are warning signs, not runtime bugs. A smelly prompt can still work by luck; a clean one raises the odds.

Category	Smell	Smelly example	Fix	Code-smell analog
I. Context & clarity	**1. Vague Context**	"Explain software architecture."	Name audience, level, topics	Uninitialized variable
	2. Ambiguous References	"They changed it because of a problem."	Replace *they/it* with nouns	Dangling pointer
	3. Format Ambiguity	"Give me some risk recommendations."	Ask for a table with named columns	Primitive Obsession
II. Complexity	**4. Overloaded Prompt**	"Design UML, DB, Java and tests for an LMS."	Split into reviewed turns	God Class / Long Method
	5. Prompt Bloat	200 words of intro before the request	Cut filler; state the task first	Dead Code / Speculative Generality
	6. Unnecessary Repetition	"Keep it simple, make it easy, don't complicate."	State the constraint once	Duplicated Code
	7. Conflicting Constraints	"A 100-page thesis in 100 words."	Resolve the conflict; set priorities	Mutually exclusive flags
III. Semantic & quality	**8. Irrelevant Persona**	"Act as a Nobel astronaut... What is Java?"	Persona only if it changes the output	Inappropriate Subclassing
	9. Loaded / Biased Framing	"Explain why X is far superior to Y."	Ask for a balanced trade-off analysis	Hardcoded return / bias
	10. Audience Mismatch	Kubernetes CIDR jargon for a board	Match vocabulary to the reader	Type incompatibility

3.2 Prompt Smell Scanner

```
1. "software"/"architecture", no audience, scope or depth?   -> Vague Context
2. "it", "they", "this problem", "the changes" unnamed?      -> Ambiguous References
3. "recommendations"/"analysis" with no output structure?    -> Format Ambiguity
4. Requirements + architecture + code + tests + slides?      -> Overloaded Prompt (God Prompt)
5. 3 paragraphs of "Imagine you are a world-class expert"?   -> Prompt Bloat
6. "Keep it simple. Make it easy. Don't be complex."?         -> Unnecessary Repetition
7. "A comprehensive 10-page analysis in exactly 50 words"?    -> Conflicting Constraints
8. "Act as a pirate astronaut... What is an Interface?"       -> Irrelevant Persona
9. "Why microservices are obviously 100x better"?             -> Loaded Framing
10. Assembly-level detail sent to a board of directors?       -> Audience Mismatch
```

SECTION 4: CREATIONAL DESIGN PATTERNS

4.1 The 5 GoF Creational Patterns

Creational patterns hide how objects are created, composed and represented.

Pattern	Core intent	Use when	Mechanism
Singleton	Exactly **one instance** plus a global access point.	Shared resource: connection pool, logger, config.	Private constructor, static instance
Factory Method	Subclasses choose which single class to create.	Framework fixes the workflow; subclasses pick the product.	**Inheritance** (override factory method)
Abstract Factory	Create **families of related products**.	Modes/themes (Online/Offline, Mac/Win) with 2+ parts each.	**Composition** (inject a factory)
Builder	Build a complex object step by step.	Many constructor params, optional settings.	Method chaining `builder.setX().build()`
Prototype	Make new objects by **cloning** one.	Costly creation (DB fetch, complex state).	`clone()` / deep copy

4.2 Factory Vocabulary: 6 Terms, Only 2 Are GoF

Term	Meaning	GoF?
1. Factory	Umbrella word for anything that creates objects	No
2. Creation Method	A method wrapping a `new` call in a normal class	No
3. Static Creation Method	`public static` creator (`LocalDate.now()`, `List.of()`)	No
4. Simple Factory	One class with a `switch` that builds objects from an argument	No
5. Factory Method	**Inheritance**: abstract method; subclass picks the product	**YES**
6. Abstract Factory	**Composition**: interface creating **families of products**	**YES**

4.3 Singleton

Intent: one instance, one global access point. **3 criteria:** *uniqueness* (logger, driver, pool), *accessible* via `getInstance()`, *extensible* by subclassing without breaking clients.

5 Java implementations

1. **Eager:** `private static final Singleton INSTANCE = new Singleton();` Thread-safe via class loading; not lazy.
2. **Synchronized method:** `public static synchronized getInstance()`. Lazy, but locks on every call.
3. **Double-Checked Locking:** lazy and fast; `volatile` is mandatory (stops instruction reordering that exposes a half-built object).
4. **Bill Pugh holder:** lazy, thread-safe, no locking cost.
5. **Enum** (Bloch): `enum EnumSingleton { INSTANCE; }`. Best; safe against reflection and serialization.

```
// 3. DCL                                          // 4. Bill Pugh
private static volatile Dcl instance;              private static class Holder {
public static Dcl getInstance() {                      static final S INSTANCE = new S(); }
  if (instance == null) {                          public static S getInstance() { return Holder.INSTANCE; }
    synchronized (Dcl.class) {
      if (instance == null) instance = new Dcl(); } }
  return instance; }
```

4 attacks and fixes: *Reflection* (`setAccessible(true)`): throw `IllegalStateException` in the constructor if an instance exists. *Serialization*: add `readResolve() { return getInstance(); }`. *Cloning*: override `clone()` to throw `CloneNotSupportedException`. *Thread race*: use `volatile` DCL, Bill Pugh, or enum.

4.4 Factory Method vs Abstract Factory

	Factory Method	Abstract Factory
Creates	**One product** type	**A family** of related products
Mechanism	**Inheritance**: subclass overrides creation method	**Composition**: client gets a factory object injected
Structure	Creator has `createProduct()`	Factory interface has `createProductA()`, `createProductB()`
New variant	1 subclass + 1 product class	1 factory class implementing all family methods

	Factory Method	Abstract Factory
Client	Calls the creator's business logic	Uses the injected factory to assemble related parts

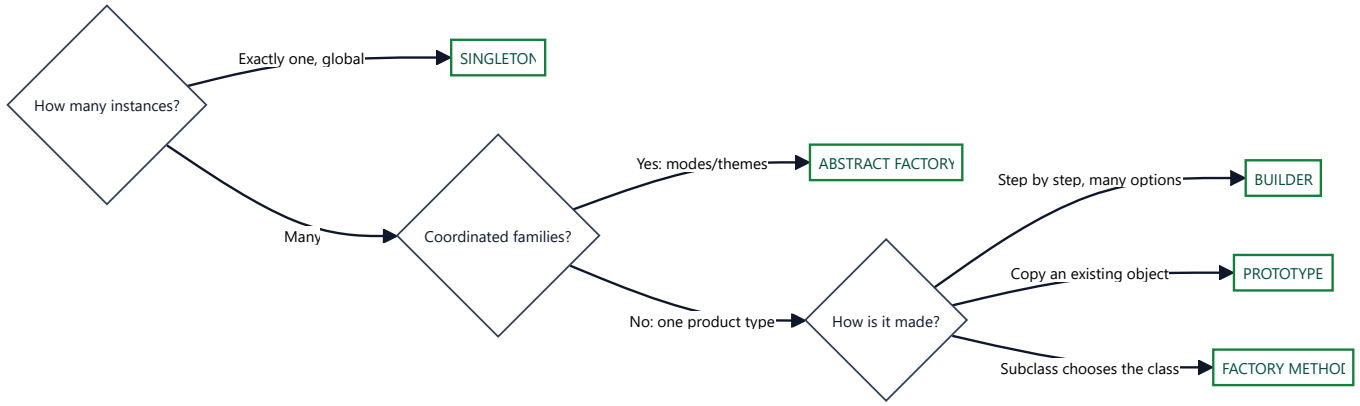
4.5 Abstract Factory: 7-Step Recipe

1. **Product matrix:** product types (`Button`, `Checkbox`) against families (`Win`, `Mac`).
2. **Abstract products:** one interface per product type.
3. **Concrete products:** one class per type for *every* family (`WinButton`, `MacButton`, ...).
4. **Abstract factory:** one interface with a create method for *each* abstract product.
5. **Concrete factories:** one per family (`WinFactory`, `MacFactory`), each building its own products.
6. **Runtime setup:** pick the concrete factory at startup from config, environment or user input.
7. **Client:** receives the factory by constructor injection and uses only interfaces (zero coupling to concrete classes).

Lab Scenario 1: EduSphere LMS. Matrix: `Lecture`, `Assessment` x `Online`, `Offline`.

- Abstract products: `Lecture` (`deliverClass()`, `shareStudyMaterials()`); `Assessment` (`conductAssessment()`, `publishResults()`).
- Online: `OnlineLecture` (live video / portal recordings), `OnlineAssessment` (MCQ quiz / auto-graded results).
- Offline: `OfflineLecture` (classroom / printed handouts), `OfflineAssessment` (paper exam / notice board).
- Factory: `CourseComponentFactory` with `createLecture()`, `createAssessment()`; implemented by `OnlineCourseFactory`, `OfflineCourseFactory`. `Course` takes the factory in its constructor.

4.6 Creational Scenario Decision Guide



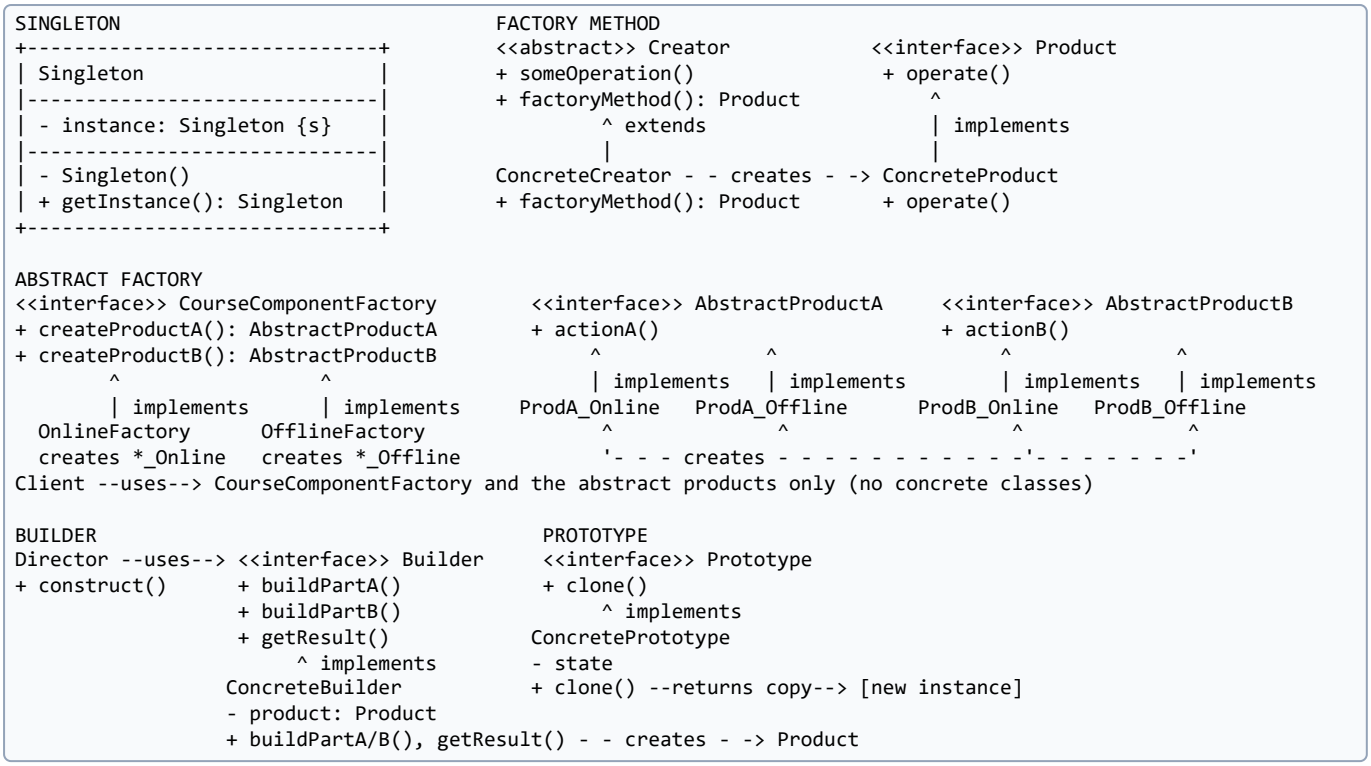
Keyword triggers

Scenario says...	Pattern	Participants to draw
"one shared resource", "global access point", "prevent multiple connections"	**Singleton**	`Singleton` (`-instance`, `-Singleton()`, `+getInstance()`)
"framework decides when, subclasses decide which class"	**Factory Method**	`Creator`, `ConcreteCreator`, `Product`, `ConcreteProduct`
"modes/themes (Online/Offline, Mac/Win), each with 2+ coordinated parts"	**Abstract Factory**	`AbstractFactory`, `ConcreteFactories`, `AbstractProductA/B`, `ConcreteProducts`
"step-by-step construction", "optional parameters", "method chaining"	**Builder**	`Builder`, `ConcreteBuilder`, `Director`, `Product`
"avoid costly creation by copying a configured instance"	**Prototype**	`Prototype` (`clone()`), `ConcretePrototype`

5-part full-marks answer

1. **Pattern and intent:** GoF name plus a one-sentence definition.
2. **Problem:** hardcoded `new ConcreteClass()` breaks OCP and DIP and couples the client to concrete classes.
3. **SOLID gained:** *OCP* (add products/factories without editing the client), *SRP* (creation logic isolated), *DIP* (client depends on abstractions).
4. **Participant table:** map each noun in the problem to a GoF role.
5. **Class diagram and Java skeleton:** correct arrow types and interface/class stubs.

4.7 UML Class Diagrams



UML arrows

Relationship	Line
Inheritance (`extends`)	Solid line, hollow triangle at superclass
Realization (`implements`)	Dashed line, hollow triangle at interface
Dependency (`uses/creates`)	Dashed line, open arrow at the dependency
Association (`has a field`)	Solid line, open arrow
Aggregation (shared collection)	Solid line, hollow diamond at owner
Composition (lifecycle tied to owner)	Solid line, filled diamond at owner